



All Gigabyte X58 motherboards now officially support NVIDIA SLI Technology

Need for speed

A-DATA reveals new line of products, including the highest speed compact flash card and new SSD drives at COMPUTEX Taipei 2009

Intel Dot Station

Great option for educational institutes

The Intel Dot Station is a desktop PC aimed at customers with an extremely low budget. It's a no-hassle PC from the looks of it.

The PC comes in a package the size of a monitor. The display is a 14-inch CRT and all the components are enclosed in the

case. The design looks like an old Mac. There is a fan to blow air off the top of the case, which cools most of the enclosure. The bottom of the case gets hot though. There's also a phone attached to the PC.

We received a low-end version of the Dot Station. The system configuration is outdated, but the system is targeted at users who don't necessarily have present day requirements. No operating system comes pre-installed, so you'll have to install your own. The 10 GB hard drive will let you install basic software. An option for an 80 GB hard drive is available for those who want more space.

A USB keyboard with a trackpad is supplied with the Dot Station. It's

compact, and is good enough to type mails or browse. The only irritants are the non-standard positioning of the [Esc] and function keys.

Obviously, our current day benchmarks wouldn't run on the system. With only 10 GB of disk space, we tried to copy files using USB and the speeds were slow — it took over an hour to transfer a 4 GB file over the USB 1.1 port.

The speakers on this machine are pretty good and despite its limited power, it plays standard definition DivX movies easily.

For everyday all-purpose use, we wouldn't recommend this. There are far superior desktop configurations that you can get for a little over Rs. 12,000.

However, at Rs. 6,500, the Dot Station is built for those who just cannot afford a Rupee over this price, or for computer labs in schools to introduce their students to PCs.

Contact

ThinPC Technology Pvt Ltd
Phone: +91-22-2859-2822 / 2859-2824

Email: info@thinpc.co.in
Web site: www.tinypc.co.in
Price: Rs. 6,500

Specifications

Intel Pentium III 600 MHz, i810 motherboard, 256 MB SDRAM, 10 GB HDD

RATINGS

Features	6.5
Performance	4
Build Quality	6.5
Value for money	8
Overall	6

Canon PowerShot SX10 IS

Sniper-scope grade zoom

Contact

Canon India Private Limited
Phone: 1-800-180-33-66
Email: info@canon.co.in
Web site: www.canon.co.in
Price: Rs. 25,995

Specifications

10 MP, 1 / 2.3-inch CCD sensor
20x optical zoom (28 - 560 mm)
2.5-inch LCD
Shutter speed: 15 - 1/3200 sec
Aperture range: f2.8 - f5.7

Canon's new SX10 IS is a 10 MP camera with an enormous 20x optical zoom that makes it perfect for telephoto shots.

It's a little larger than most point-and-shoot cameras, and features a provision to mount a flash. There's a foldable screen, which makes taking photos in awkward angles very simple, but it's only a 2.5-inch. The camera is powered by four AA batteries that significantly increase its weight. The body feels heavy, but the side of the hand grip doesn't feel very sturdy.

With this kind of zoom, the image stabilisation has to be good. The SX10's image stabilisation works well on really close range shots, but at the telephoto end, things get out of control. The in-built flash is powerful and useful to light up large areas. The focus-assist light is also powerful.

The SX10 has a nice set of additions. The dedicated video recording button is one of them. The image preview buttons are lined up neatly on the right side of the camera.

Enhancements in the interface are in the form of animations for changing aperture size and shutter speed.

Image quality is decent in well-lit areas, but turning the ISO level up beyond 800 adds a lot of noise to the image. Below is 800, the grain is within acceptable limits. Colours look normal and clicking macro photos are easy. Images aren't as crisp as expected at optimum lighting conditions. In low-light scenes, we had some problems focussing. With it's huge zoom, the motor adds a little vibration while shooting.

Although the huge zoom is very rare to find in a camera, it's not impressive either. The use for 20x optical zoom isn't very necessary for every user but it's a nice thing to have. Rs. 25,995 is still a decent price keeping in mind everything about this camera.

RATINGS

Features	8
Performance	7
Build Quality	7
Value for money	7
Overall	7

